Chapter 6

Christian Demonology

Christian Demonology, a subset of Angelology (the study of angels), gives light on a variety of questions, including who or what demons are, what they do, who or what they serve, and what happens to them after death. This chapter is broken down into two parts for the reader to understand Christian Demonology through a wider lens.

The first part of the chapter will go over the basic questions one has in terms of demonology according to the biblical verses, the functions demons perform with several examples, their names, and more in-depth research on Christian demonology. Furthermore, this part of the chapter also aids in dealing with some concerns many have regarding biblical writings and allows one to find solutions within this chapter.

To begin with, according to the Bible, devils are former angels who rejected God. These devils, led by Satan, seek to deceive the inhabitants of this world. Satan and a vast number of angels were expelled from heaven because of their disobedience against God. Despite being recounted in the Bible, the exact dates of these events are not specified. Angels were created with a degree of free will comparable to humans. God did not force angels to revolt, although some did so under Satan's influence. The Bible mentions people who were possessed or under the control of evil spirits. However, there are no documented cases of Christians afflicted by demons. Those who are indwelt by the Holy Spirit of God are immune to possession and demonic influence. However, demons can continue to tempt Christians. Satan tempted Jesus in the wilderness as well (Matthew 4:1-11).

According to 1 Peter 5:8, Satan remains active in the world today. It is reasonable to assume that other fallen angels do the same. According to legend, the Nephilim were created when "the sons of God" mated with "the daughters of man" (Genesis 6:4).

Nephilim can refer to either fallen beings or monstrous humans. The fact that they are mentioned before the account of Noah's ark shows that they significantly contributed to the amount of wickedness on Earth at that time. Although the identity of the "sons of God" is debatable, a large number of people believed they were fallen angels.

Many people in the contemporary world either do not believe in Satan and demons or view him as a mere symbol of evil. According to the Bible, demonology is the study of the presence and conduct of devils. Further, Ephesians 6:12 makes it apparent that the Christian life is a spiritual fight in the heavenly realms. "For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against rulers, authorities, cosmic powers over this present darkness, and spiritual forces of evil in the high places." In response, 1 John 4:4 states, "Little children, you are from God, and you have overcome them because he who is in you is greater than he who is in the world."

Here is a basic introduction to the biblical concept of the demonic world.

It is essential to remember that different spirits can cause different types of problems in a person's life, some of which appear physically, some psychologically, and others as occult skills or powers.

Luke 13:11 and 16 demonstrate the effectiveness of physical influence. “And behold, a woman was tormented with a spirit of infirmity for eighteen years, and she was hunched over and unable to stand up straight. And shouldn't this daughter of Abraham, whom Satan has enslaved for the past eighteen years, be released on the Sabbath?” Similarly, in Matthew 9:33, the deaf talked after the demon was cast out, and the crowds were astonished, stating, "It had never been seen in Israel before."

Luke 8:27–35 is a parable about the influence of the mind (also soul, spirit, etc.). As he landed, he encountered a long-time demon-possessed, nude guy who lived in a graveyard. When they came down to Jesus' feet, they found the man from whom the devils were thrown, clothed and in his right mind. In addition to these words, Matthew 17:15–18 states, "Lord, have mercy on my son; for he is insane and very distressed; for he often falls into the fire and the water... And after Jesus had rebuked the devil, the devil left the child, and the child was afterwards healed.” The English word lunatic is derived from the Greek word *seleniazomai,* which means "crazy" or "moonstruck" in the New Testament (mentally ill).

1 Samuel 16:14 describes one such case of mental suffering at the hands of evil spirits: "Now the Spirit of the LORD had left Saul, and the LORD sent a tormenting spirit that filled him with despair and fear." (NLT) Likewise, in Matthew 15:22, “And behold, a Canaanite woman arrived from the same beaches, pleading with him, ‘Have mercy on me, O Lord, son of David; my daughter is horribly afflicted by a demon.’" (If you’re annoyed, it’s because a nasty spirit is harassing you.)

“And it came to pass, as we went to pray, that a certain girl possessed by a spirit of divination, who brought her masters great profit through soothsaying, encountered us” (Acts 16:16). This is an example of an occult-powered spirit. Future prediction is a

soothsaying, or a charmer, or a spirit medium, or a sorcerer, or a necromancer. See also Deuteronomy 18:11. “I am the LORD, your God,” and Leviticus 19:31 states, "Have no fear of them who have familiar spirits, nor seek out magicians."

In addition to demons, other types of spirits, such as kings, queens, principalities, etc., inhabit the demonic world.

In Luke 13:11, it is stated that a spirit of infirmity led a woman to stoop, while in Acts 16:16, it is stated that a young girl possessed a spirit of divination that gave her the capacity to tell fortunes.

Some demons cannot be expelled with a simple command. Jesus Christ, in Matthew 17:14-21, says the following: “When they reached the throng, a father bowed before Jesus and said, ‘Lord, have pity on my son; for he is insane and very distressed; for he falls often into the fire and often into the water. I brought him to your people, but they were unable to assist him.’ Jesus replied, ‘O faithless and perverse generation, how much longer will I be with you? How much longer am I expected to endure this? Bring him to me now.’ The demon immediately departed the youngster once Jesus exorcised him. The group of disciples then approached Jesus privately and asked, ‘Why were we unable to expel him?’ And Jesus said to them, ‘Because of your unbelief: for truly I say to you, if you have faith as a mustard seed, you can command this mountain to move from here to there, and it will move; and nothing will be difficult for you.’ Nevertheless, ‘THIS KIND can only be expelled through the power of prayer and fasting.’"

Now, the disciples of Jesus were regular exorcists and had expelled numerous devils (Mark 6:13). As a result of their lack of confidence, they were unable to exterminate 'this sort' of creature. Jesus identified this particular type of demon and made it clear that we must do more than simply command it to depart. Even if the only requirement was prayer, I could not recall another location in the New Testament where we are asked to "pray" prior to a regular deliverance. However, Jesus made it clear that prayer must precede any attempt to exorcise "this kind" of evil. This devil appeared to be more difficult to expel than usual, needing larger efforts (prayer, fasting, faith) than usual.

According to Matthew 12:45, demons come in a variety of degrees of evil.

“Then he departs and returns with seven more demons eviler than himself; they enter and stay there; and the man's last condition is worse than his first. Thus, must it be with this wicked generation.”

Alongside this, there is also a hierarchy within demons as well.

As stated previously, we may encounter demons of various strengths during a deliverance. In addition, the Bible has evidence of a demon hierarchy (different levels of demons). Jesus of Nazareth, whom God anointed with the Holy Spirit and with authority, went about doing good and healing all who were demon-possessed (Acts 10:38).

A proper translation of the New Testament Greek into modern English indicates that the phrase "oppressed by the devil" refers to a situation in which a demonic hierarchy exerts control over the victim. If we look up the term "celestial hierarchy," we immediately learn that it refers to the normal arrangement of the stars.

According to Ephesians 6:12, this hierarchy is also in action when we "wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of this age's darkness, and against spiritual wickedness in high places."

A possessed individual may possess multiple demons. Mark 16:9 states that as Jesus rose early on the first day of the week, he first appeared to Mary Magdalene, from whom he had expelled seven demons.

Luke 11:24 and 26 state, "When the unclean spirit has left a man, he wanders through desolate places seeking rest; and finding none, he declares, 'I will return to my house from which I came.' Then, he brings seven extra, even more terrible souls to reside with him, and they move in. This man's final condition is worse than his initial condition."

Then he asked, "What is your name?" And he responded, "My name is Legion because we are numerous." (Mark 5:9)

Additionally, it appears that they work well together. Even though hundreds of souls were staying in the man at the time, there was no turmoil as Jesus approached. One of them volunteered to be the speaker and leader of the group, and the others followed his or her lead into the pig pen. The fact that the guiding spirit responded with "we" indicates that they were working together.

It is common to encounter a powerful spirit surrounded by a group of subordinates hiding from the light, according to experts in the field.

In the Bible, demons were exorcised from individuals several times, and each time they manifested in some fashion. Several examples include the following:

"And after the demonic spirit tore him apart and screamed with a loud voice, he came out of him." Mark 1:26. Correct usage of the phrase cried in this context is "screamed."

Induce a seizure in the victim. Luke 9:42 states, "And while he was still coming, the devil threw him down and tore him." Jesus cast out the evil spirit, healed the child, and

returned him to his father. The Greek term for "torn" in the New Testament means "to convulse with epilepsy."

Excessive salivation (Mark 9:20): “And they brought him before him, and immediately the spirit tore him apart, and he fell to the ground foaming at the mouth.”

The Bible does not present us with an exhaustive list of all that demonic possession can do, nor does it claim to do so, but it does supply us with some useful examples to help us prepare for what may occur. The Bible is comparable to a storybook in that it contains personal experiences of exorcism and the lessons to be learned from them. However, we cannot presume that every exorcism will resemble those described in the Bible.

When a demon was expelled from me, I witnessed a manifestation that I do not believe is described in the Bible, and I am aware of many other things that demons do as they leave a person that is not mentioned in the Bible. They nevertheless occur and cannot be disputed. The Bible makes no claim to be an exhaustive guide to everything that demons can do when they first arrive. The Bible is more of a storybook than a historical record, and we may learn a great deal from its stories. However, a great deal of demonic activity is not recorded in the Bible.

To gain a greater understanding of an "issue" in the Bible, one must approach it as befits its role as God's message. This technique may be articulated in greater detail through three lenses: the normative, the situational, and the existential. A normative worldview compels us to admit that the God of the Bible is superior to us. Because this God is incomprehensible, the Bible will always include mysteries that defy explanation. By considering the "problem" in its broader context, we can have a better understanding of how to tackle it. An existentialist investigation of our responses to God's Word reveals our underlying emotions, such as pride or sorrow, in the face of the mysteries we discover there.

John M. Frame has persuasively proven that there are three sides to human ethical decision-making, which can be expressed clearly by the normative, situational, and existential perspectives. The normative approach to ethics examines moral ideas in terms of socially accepted norms for conduct, worldview, and character. God's goodness, which is the ultimate standard, comes first, followed by the biblical standards that function as God's mandates to humans. The second characteristic of the situational viewpoint is its emphasis on the external environment. One method to adopt a situational perspective is to consider what can be done to bring God greater honor. The existential perspective is concerned with what motivates and inspires humans. Love should be our major motive, first for God and then for one another (Matt. 22:37–40).

Now one might wonder: How might we employ these three viewpoints when presented with apparent problems in the Bible?

In the normative position, God is emphasized as the ultimate arbiter of truth and righteousness. When God speaks, his words carry with them tremendous weight. The Bible is God's means of communication with humanity. According to other sources (see B. B. Warfield and Kevin DeYoung below, among others), the Bible is God's word (2 Tim. 3:16–17). Therefore, it has the authority of the All-Powerful God and can be depended upon. Before digging into the particulars of a text or doctrine in the Bible, we must have faith in its overall reliability. Instead of keeping our doubts to ourselves, we should be truthful with God and inform him when they arise. Taking God at his word alone will, of course, not solve anything. Nonetheless, it provides a helpful spiritual foundation for addressing the problems.

Another advantage of accepting God's incomprehensibility is enabling us to enjoy his magnificence fully. Some things in the Bible are not crystal clear, but God makes it abundantly apparent what we need to know for our salvation. In other words, God is unfathomable, and we finite people will never fully comprehend him. Despite our attempts, we will never truly comprehend who he is. Only God has a complete understanding of himself. As a result, there will be unanswered questions regarding the Bible.

For example, the nature of the Trinity remains a mystery to this day. Only God has a comprehensive understanding of himself, so it will always remain a mystery. Understanding that a triune God is one God is challenging for us. If people spend too much time attempting to comprehend God, they may begin to assume that they are godlike. Then, their pride leads them to deviate from the truth.

There are some things in them that are difficult to understand, which the ignorant and unstable distort to their own detriment, as they do with the other Scriptures, thereby creating a mystery (2 Pet. 3:16).

Finally, the fact that we lack sufficient information may result in enigmas. For example, if two tales of the exorcism of the Gadarene man plagued by a demon contradict each other, we may or may not be able to provide a fair explanation because we were not present and do not know all of the important material.

We will look at the various ontologies (natures) of fallen angels, demonic spirits, and demons (daimons) mentioned in the Judeo-Christian scriptures in this series on biblical demonology.

The name "demonology" conjures up ideas from Hammer Horror films and medieval grimoires of various demons and goetia that can be summoned to provide "spiritual room service" for their supposed master and summoner. Several pictures come to me when I think of the phrase "demonology."

As a result of all this, Christians are under the misconception that they should avoid walking in this area. However, we cannot begin to understand the biblical references to these beings until we realize that humanity has had ideas about them for around two thousand years. This is required in order to carry out the activity. Many of these are not contained in the Bible, but they have had an impact on human imaginations and understandings, culminating in the construction of the previously described demonological imagery.

The Church Tradition has contributed to what the Scriptures teach about this specific subject of study over time, divorcing them from their original contexts and making it more difficult for us to understand what they are saying. It's possible that the biblical authors had no intention of expressing the characteristics of these beings that we think have a biblical origin. And so, a contextual analysis is required to improve our understanding of the Bible's teachings on these topics.

When it comes to demons in the twenty-first century, ideologies that simplify spiritual geography usually deceive us. As a result, we think demons are the result of medical insanity, horned and hideous Buffy characters, or fallen angels. On the other side, we believe demons are the result of mental sickness. The vast majority of these beliefs are not referenced in the Bible and were never embraced by Mesopotamian, Syro-Phonecian, Greco-Roman, or Judeo-Christian communities throughout the 1400 years that the Bible was written and compiled. This is erroneous and results from the previously mentioned fusion of contradictory teachings.

To explore the supernatural in the Bible, one must first be able to investigate the powers of darkness stated in the Bible rationally and logically. This is one of the conditions for completing the action. Many Christians will have run a mile at this point because we are constantly warned not to explore such material, to be weary of it, and to investigate it as a subject, lest we become "infected" in some way. Many Christians will have avoided this since we are frequently told not to research such things, to be wary of them, and to avoid them as a subject. Certainly, as C. S. Lewis pointed out, there are plausible explanations for why people say such things:

"Regarding devils, our race is capable of making not one but two diametrically opposing errors. One option is to refuse to acknowledge their presence. Aside from trusting in them, another option is to develop a healthy concern for them."

The Screwtape Letters' introduction was written by C. S. Lewis.

Because of reason and the demythologizing of the Bible, some people are deceived by the first fallacy, whereas "spirit-filled" forms of Christianity are frequently misled by the second mistake. They have a tendency to see demons everywhere, particularly in anything spiritual or otherwise beyond their comprehension. As a result, they categorize everything as demonic.

We should strive for a more balanced perspective, acknowledging that some haunting stories will have scientific answers, while others may be the consequence of specific types of spirit beings.

I believe that these concepts are extremely important to grasp. It is important to be in sync with the Holy Spirit. We must be aware of our physical and spiritual surroundings and be aware of our opponents as part of this task. If these aliens are real, they will have an impact on humanity, and we should be aware of it.

For a good reason, the beings depicted in the Bible are described in vivid detail.

God has entrusted us with the task of learning how to win His approval (2 Tim 2:15).

God wrote the entire Bible as a source of guidance, instruction, reproof, and correction, as well as training in virtuous living so that we may obtain the knowledge and skills needed to perform every act of kindness (2 Tim 3:16-17).

As a result, biblical demonology is a valid topic of study as long as we stick to the Scriptures and cultures of those times. The list of abbreviations used in this series is as follows.

2TP is an abbreviation for the Second Temple Period (536 BCE to 70 CE)

Anchor Version (ABD) Bible Dictionary of the Prehistoric Middle East (ANE) The Book of the Observers, abbreviated as BW (1 Enoch 1-36) Dictionary of Biblical Gods and Demons (see Bibliography)

The NT stands for the New Testament, and the DSS stands for the Dead Sea Scrolls.

There is evidence in the 2nd Temple Period (2TP) Jewish texts, New Testament (NT) writings, and early Christian literature that these species and their distinctions were understood before and after Jesus' time. We can clearly understand the mission that Jesus and the early Church were seeking to accomplish and the characteristics of the deliverance ministry that emerged at this time. A thorough understanding of the

demonic is essential to fully comprehend Jesus' life and work. "Jesus' exorcism ministry did not precede the kingdom, but rather the active kingdom of God."

To portray God's Kingdom in a missional manner in each of our particular circumstances, we must have only a rudimentary comprehension of these beings.

Chapter 7

Demonology Through the Ages

The concept of demons and their mythology has existed for a very long time; in fact, it predates human records and is common knowledge in many religions and cultures worldwide. Every culture has its own perception and belief about demons that have been passed down through generations. The term "devil" is derived from the Greek word "daimon," which means "a supernatural spirit or power of a lesser kind." In this chapter, we will be overviewing different ages, cultures, and races that have viewed and evaluated the existence and workings of demons.

There was no clear distinction between gods and demons before the arrival of one of the most followed religions, Islam. Jinns, or genies, are supernatural beings who live alongside humans and angels. Allah (God) created them from a kind of fire that does not emit smoke. The belief explains how in addition to humans, the Jinn were the only species with free will. Jinns could take on human and animal forms to manipulate men into doing good or bad things. According to the Qur'an (a holy book followed by Muslims), this alignment is led by a Jinn called Iblis, also known as the Devil.

According to tradition, Iblis refused to kneel to Adam, the first ever man created by Allah, because Iblis considered himself higher than any other entity. Iblis' main argument was that he was made of fire and Adam was not. Due to this tussle, he was banned and transferred to Jahannam (hell). Islam speaks openly about him as the devil because he misguides the human race by luring them with sinful whispers.

In Jewish tradition, Lilith is considered the ‘evilest’ of all demons. She is said to have been Adam's first wife, preceding Eve, who was given to Adam by God. Lilith resisted Adam's attempt to have her lie beneath him during their sexual encounter and stood her ground. Their argument led to her leaving and going to the Red Sea to curse the three angels God had sent to bring her back to Adam. It is believed that she did it because she did not want to be ruled by a man.

Later, Lilith fell in love with a demon and became pregnant with more than a hundred children every day during her time in the Red Sea. God promised that if she did not return to Adam, she would no longer have to deal with her demon children. She continued to reject the orders, so she was punished, and Adam was given Eve to take Lilith's place. After receiving God's retribution, Lilith was chosen to be Samael, the angel of deathspouse. She was believed to go on to seduce men and murder unborn babies.

While Lilith's story eventually faded, her daughters, known as the Lilim, continued to torment men for thousands of years. She and her daughters seduced men that had nocturnal emissions.

Demons play an essential role in both Hindu and Buddhist religions. Vritra, also known as "the enemy of the gods"; Yama, also known as "the Lord of Death"; and Ravana, also known as "the Demon King," are just a few of the many Hindu demons revered. Rakshasa is one of the most well-known demons throughout history, known to possess the ability to use powers to prevent humanity from following the right path and progressing spiritually.

Judaism's traditions have adopted some of Christianity's belief in the existence of demons. As discussed in the previous chapter, according to Christian beliefs, demons are fallen angels who conspire against God and his realm under the leadership of Satan. They were expelled from heaven by the archangel Michael and the other holy angels and banished to Earth. Because the conflict occurred long before human records were kept and possibly even before humans existed, very little is known about the battle to drive the rebels from the skies. In this religion, as in many others, there are numerous demons, each with a specific function. Christians who follow more liberal interpretations of the Bible no longer believe in the reality of demons and regard references to demons in the Bible as meaningless in today's world. On the other hand, many traditional forms of Christianity continue to believe that they are demons.

The creatures between the holy and profane realms take many forms across different religions. Heavenly and atmospheric beings; devils, demons, and evil spirits; ghosts, ghouls, and goblins; and nature spirits and fairies are among them.

Angels and demons are typically conceived of as celestial or atmospheric spirits in Western faiths that adhere to the monotheistic worldview and see the universe as three-dimensional in Judaism, Christianity, Islam, and Zoroastrianism. Despite this, there is a widespread belief in ghosts, ghouls, goblins, demons, and evil spirits who influence humans' terrestrial conditions and actions. This idea can be found in various religions' popular piety. Celestial entities can be either kind or cruel depending on their association with the Supreme Being. On the other hand, demons and evil spirits that generally influence humans in their role as terrestrial beings (rather than in their destiny as superterrestrial beings) are viewed as having bad intentions in popular piety — and to some extent in theological reflection. This is true if they impact human destiny as superterrestrial beings or play a role as terrestrial beings.

Angels are frequently organized into orders of four, six, or seven within the first ranks of their hierarchy. Sometimes, multiple orders may exist. The Abrahamic religions, including Judaism, Christianity, and Islam, use the number four because it has perfectionistic connotations and is associated with the four cardinal points. Early Zoroastrianism, heavily influenced by ancient Iranian astronomical and astrological sciences, combined the concept of the seven known planetary spheres with its belief in the heptad (grouping of seven) of celestial beings—i.e., Ahura Mazd's amesha spentas. Ahura Mazd's amesha spentas are as follows: Spenta Mainyu (the Holy Spirit), Voh (Immortality).

Later in Zoroastrianism's history, Ahura Mazda and Spenta Mainyu became synonymous. That was not the case in the Gths, which were early hymns thought to have been written by Zoroaster, or in the Avesta, which were sacred scriptures. Furthermore, the remaining bounteous immortals were arranged in a six-person order. The counterpart of the Holy Spirit, Angra Mainyu, who later became the great adversary Ahriman (the prototype of the Jewish, Christian, and Islamic Satan), and the Daevas, who were most likely gods in early Indo-Iranian religion, stood against the bountiful immortals. These immortals helped link the spiritual and material worlds together and aided in integrating the spiritual and material worlds.

The Daevas Akman (Evil Mind), Indr-vya (Death), Saurva (a daeva of death and sickness), Nhaithya (a daeva related to the Vedic god Nsatya), Tauru (difficult to identify), and Zairi fought alongside Angra Mainyu against Ahura Mazd (the personification of haoma, the sacred drink related to the sacrifices of both ahuras and daevas). Other demonic figures include Aashma (violence, fury, or the aggressive impulse), Z (Concupiscence or Lust), Mithrndruj (He Who Lies to Mithra or False Speech), Jh (the demon whore, created later by Ahriman to defile the human race), and a slew of others. Aashma is another name for (see also Zoroastrianism).

Angelology and demonology developed in Judaism during and after the Babylonian Exile (6th-5th centuries BCE), when relations were established with Zoroastrianism. Yahweh is referred to as the Lord of Hosts throughout the Hebrew Bible. These hosts (Sabaoth) are heavenly armies that fought against evil and performed a variety of missions, such as guarding the door to paradise, punishing evildoers, protecting the faithful, and exposing the Word of God to humanity. They also carried out several other tasks.

The canonical Hebrew Bible mentions two archangels: Michael, known as the warrior leader of the celestial legions, and Gabriel, known as the heavenly messenger. Two archangels are mentioned in the book of Tobit, the apocryphal Hebrew Bible: Raphael, who is described as God's healer or helper, and Uriel, who is the "Fire of God," described as the watcher over the earth and the lowest part of hell. Tobit 12:15 mentions seven different archangels, but only four are explicitly named. Other angel orders, such as the cherubim and seraphim, were also mentioned previously. One of these other orders was the archangels.

As a result of the influence of Zoroastrianism, Satan, known as the adversary, most likely evolved into the archdemon. Other demons included Lilith, a feminine night demon; Azazel, the demon of the wilderness took the form of a scapegoat; and Leviathan and Rahab, both of whom were disorder demons. Jews inspired by folk beliefs and customs (as Christians would later be) frequently carried protective charms, amulets, and talismans inscribed with potent formulas. This was done to repel the demonic and evil forces that threatened them (See also Judaism).

During certain periods in Christian Europe, particularly during the Middle Ages, those suspected of practicing diabolical rites, such as the black mass, faced the wrath of both the church and the people. This was due to the worship of demons and the practice of witchcraft, which caused this wrath. "Hocus-pocus," an abbreviated version of "Hoc est corpus meum," the words of institution in the Eucharist, or Holy Communion, has persisted since the "black mass" (the mass said in reverse and with an inverted crucifix on the altar). This formula is commonly used in magic. Witchcraft and sorcery have traditionally been strongly associated with studying demonology in Christian thought, particularly in the Western world.

With a growing interest in the supernatural, there were signs of a revival of demon worship and black magic in the second half of the twentieth century. However, this was primarily limited to small cults that proved transient.

In Islam, angelology and demonology beliefs are closely related to Judaism and Christianity, which teach similar ideas. Along with the four angels who carry Allah's thrones, there are four other well-known angels: Jibrl (Gabriel), the angel of revelation; Mkl (Michael), the angel of nature, who provides humans with food and knowledge; Izrl,

the angel of death; and Isrfl, the angel who places one's soul in the body and sounds the trumpet for the Last Judgment. Furthermore, demons compete with one another for control over human lives. The tempter, Iblis, also known as Satan or Shayan, is the most prominent.

In Eastern religious traditions, Guanyin and the bodhisattvas are two significant figures.

As previously stated, spiritual beings known as avatars, bodhisattvas, and other such entities filled the role of angels in Eastern religions. These beings were extensions of God or the sacred and carried out the functions that angels are known for. Belief in demons was and still is widespread, and this belief has influenced a wide range of rituals and customs aimed at protecting humans and the environment from destructive forces. In Hinduism, the asuras, also known as Zoroastrian ahuras, are considered the devas' adversaries (the gods). Both sides competed for the homa, also known as the amrita (the sacred drink that bestows power). Still, the preserver god, Vishnu, took the form of a beautiful woman (Mohini) to assist the gods in obtaining the amrita for themselves. This enabled the gods to triumph over the demons.

In Hinduism, there are many different types of demons known as asuras. Nagas are demons in the form of serpents, Ahi, the demon of drought, and Kamsa are a few examples. Rakshasas and pishachas are two types of demons known to torment humans. Rakshasas are grotesque and hideous beings of various shapes said to haunt cemeteries, force people to commit heinous acts, and attack holy people. Pishachas are supernatural beings who haunt places where violent deaths have occurred.

Many Buddhists believe that demons are nothing more than forces that prevent humanity from attaining nirvana (bliss or the extinction of desire). Mara, the supreme tempter, worked with his daughters Rati (Desire), Raga (Pleasure), and Tanha (Restlessness) to prevent Siddhartha Gautama, also known as the Buddha, from attaining enlightenment. Many of the demon beings worshipped in Tibet, China, and Japan's indigenous religions found their way into the Buddhist pantheon as Mahayana (Greater Vehicle). Buddhism spread throughout these regions. The guei-shen, or demonic beings worshipped in Chinese religion, can be found in all aspects of nature.

In addition to these natural world creatures, we have goblins, fairies, and ghosts. People in China influenced by Daoism and folk religions used bonfires, firecrackers, and torches to ward off the guei because demons avoided light. Mankind must battle a plethora of demons, like in Chinese and Japanese religions. The most terrifying Japanese demons are the oni, which are malevolent spirits with great power, and the tengu, which are spirits that can possess humans and must be cast out with the help of priests in most cases.

Spiritual beings in nonliterate religions of Asia, Africa, Oceania, and the Americas are typically viewed as either malevolent or benevolent depending on the circumstances rather than their inherent nature. This contrasts with literate religions, which regard spiritual beings as either malevolent or benevolent. For example, the Yoruba people of Nigeria believe that the deity Eshu is both a protective and beneficent spirit and an evil spirit whose power can be used against one's enemies. Eshu is thought to be both of these things. These beings possess mana, which translates to "supernatural force" in Melanesia. Mana is a term that can refer to both spirits and people of high status, such as chiefs or shamans.

Nonliterate religions worship nature's spirits in exchange for specific favors or to ward off disasters, similar to how ancient Rome venerated the gods and goddesses of the natural world. There are numerous ancestor gods, so the spirits of the deceased must be appeased. This is typically accomplished through the performance of elaborate rituals.

Every nation, culture, and religion has had its myths and beliefs about demons since the beginning of time. As seen above, it doesn't matter which religion you look at; they all seem to have a lot in common regarding core principles.

Chapter 8

Impact of Christian Demonology

The story of Western civilization begins with the development and incorporation of the Bible into various aspects of daily life. According to historical evidence, Christian scientists, explorers, philosophers, artists, inventors, and writers have consistently been at the forefront of their respective fields. This assertion is challenged in James A. Haught's 2000 Years of Disbelief, which claims that for the past two millennia, no one of any significance believed the truths of Christianity, particularly in the field of science. This book is one example of an attempt to refute this assertion.

This argument, however, ignores Rodney Stark's long-held belief that "there is no inherent conflict between religion and science" and that "Christian theology was required for the birth of science." This argument also disregards the fact that "no inherent conflict exists between religion and science." He provides evidence to support

the claim that "the leading scientific figures in the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries were, in the overwhelming majority of cases, devout Christians who believed it was their duty to comprehend God's handiwork" after conducting extensive research into the Scholastic period.

On May 24, 1844, artist and inventor Samuel F. B. Morse chose the biblical verse "What hath God wrought?" (Num. 23:23) as the first telegraphic message to be sent over a long distance (160 miles). Airplane inventors Wilbur and Orville Wright, as well as Supreme Court Justice David J. Alito Jr., chose this verse as their message. The first comprehensive dictionary published in the United States was created by lexicographer Noah Webster. The title of that dictionary was "An American Dictionary of the English Language" (1828).

The illustration in the book "1,000 Years, 1,000 People: Ranking the Men and Women Who Shaped the Millennium"[11] differs greatly from the one painted by Haught. Christians accounted for half of the top ten entries, accounting for a significant portion of the top ten. The first person on the list is Johannes Gutenberg, who lived from 1394 to 1468. He is widely regarded as the inventor of the printing press. His press was used to print the Bible, which happened to be the first book printed. The second most important person on our list is Christopher Columbus, who was born in 1451 and died in 1506.

Christopher Columbus discovered a biblical command to spread the gospel, also known as "the Holy Christian Faith," throughout the entire world. Martin Luther (1483-1546) is credited with starting the Protestant Reformation and bringing linguistic standardization to Germany through his translation of the Bible into German. He accomplished both of these goals through his work on the German Bible.

Galileo Galilei (1564-1642) followed him and fundamentally altered people's perspectives of the cosmos by criticizing the church's reliance on Aristotle's cosmology in contrast to the teachings of the Bible. [13] Isaac Newton, who lived from 1642 to 1727, is credited with numerous scientific discoveries. He is also credited with developing differential and integral calculus. Isaac Newton lived between 1642 and 1727. In addition, he wrote several works on Christian theology. [14] *Observations on Daniel's Prophecies and the Apocalypse of St. John* is one of his best-known works, and it was published six years after his death. He is positioned at number six on the list.

The study of demons has been given new life thanks to Christianity, which Zoroastrianism would have approved of. Devils include Beelzebub, known as the Lord of Flies, Lucifer, who was deposed as the Bearer of Light, and Satan.

Canaan was the birthplace of Beelzebub. The Lord of the Flies was Lucifer. Satan, a fallen angel, is Jesus Christ's main adversary. Lucifer's role as Light Bearer was taken away

from him (or possibly Beelzebul, known as the Lord of Dung). The concept of the devil, as well as the name "devil," derived from the Zoroastrian word “daevas” and the Greek word “diabolos,” both of which means "slanderer" or "accuser." When Jews refer to Satan, they mean exactly what this translation implies.

The devil's primary responsibility as a single demonic force or incarnation of evil was to tempt humans into engaging in behaviors that would prevent them from fulfilling their superterrestrial destiny. We were able to complete this task by using temptation. Monks would travel to deserts in the early days of Christianity to serve as the vanguard of God's army and to battle evil spirits.

People were more likely to have visual and auditory hallucinations when hungry or tired, leading to the widespread belief that demons lived in deserts devoid of water. They frequently claimed that in visions, the devil appeared to them as alluring women, urging them to break their vows in order to maintain sexual purity in both their bodies and minds. Visions of the devil were said to have appeared to them. Seduction was used to coerce individuals into breaking their vows by engaging in sexual behavior to achieve this goal.

Those suspected of participating in demonic rituals faced both the people's wrath and the church's wrath at various points throughout Christian Europe's history, particularly during the Middle Ages when practices such as the black mass were prevalent. The fact that this circumstance resulted in the practice of witchcraft and demon worship exacerbated the rage. People have been using the term "hocus-pocus" since the time of the "black mass," which is an abbreviated version of the words of institution in the Eucharist, also known as Holy Communion.

In the realm of magical practice, this is a tried-and-true method. Witchcraft and sorcery have long been associated with the study of demons in Christian belief, particularly in the Western world. This is a particularly strong association. This organization has survived to the present day.

In the latter half of the twentieth century, there were signs that demon worship and black magic were experiencing a revival, most likely due to increased interest in the supernatural. Increased activity accompanied these revivals. Despite this, it was mostly limited to minor cults that turned out to be fleeting in nature.

The beliefs about angels and demons taught in Islam are very similar to those taught in Judaism and Christianity— two religions that are closely related to Islam. Izrl, the angel of death; Isrfl, the angel who places the soul in the body and sounds the trumpet for the Last Judgment; Jibril, also known as Gabriel, the angel of revelation; Mkl, also known as Michael, the angel of nature who provides humans with food and knowledge; and Izrl.

These four angels will now be joined by the other four angels in charge of carrying Allah's thrones. Furthermore, demons are constantly competing for control over human lives. The most well-known devil is Iblis, who is also known as ‘Satan’ or ‘Shayan.’ He is the one who leads people astray in their beliefs.

The figures of Guanyin and the bodhisattvas are revered and honored in Eastern religious traditions.

As previously stated, spiritual beings such as avatars, bodhisattvas, and other similar creatures traditionally play the role of angels in Eastern religions. These beings were extensions of God or the sacred and performed functions normally assigned to angels. Angels were recognized for their outstanding contributions to the cause. Belief in demons was and still is widespread, influencing many rituals and practices aimed at protecting humanity and the environment from destructive forces.

These rituals and practices have been passed down through generations. This category includes the following practices and habits: In Hinduism, the asuras are considered the devas' adversaries. In Zoroastrianism, these same beings are known as auras (the gods). Both parties were interested in purchasing the house, also known as the amrita (the sacred liquid that bestows power).

To aid the gods in their pursuit of amrita, the god, Vishnu, who is in charge of preservation, transformed himself into a beautiful woman (Mohini). As a direct result of this, the gods were able to triumph over the demons. In the Hindu religion, the term "Asuras" refers to a wide range of distinct types of demonic beings. The Nagas are serpent-like demons. The Ahi, a demon associated with drought, and the Kamsa are a few examples of these (an archdemon).

As previously mentioned, rakshasas and pishachas are two types of demons that are known to be responsible for causing human suffering. Rakshasas are horrifying and repulsive monstrous beings who can manifest themselves in a variety of ways. They are said to lurk in cemeteries, manipulate people into evil deeds, and attack holy people.

It is said that supernatural beings known as pishachas can be found lingering in places where violent deaths have occurred. Many Buddhists believe that demons are nothing more than obstacles that humanity must overcome in order to reach nirvana (bliss or the extinction of desire). Mara, also known as the "Ultimate Tempter," worked with his three daughters, Rati (Desire), Raga (Pleasure), and Tanha (Restlessness), to prevent Siddhartha Gautama, also known as the Buddha, from attaining enlightenment.

Tanha was the most prosperous of the three. Many of the demonic entities venerated in the indigenous religions of Tibet, China, and Japan found their way into the Buddhist

pantheon as Mahayana (Greater Vehicle). Buddhism spread throughout these regions due to the Mahayana's emphasis on rebirth and reincarnation.

Demonic spirits known as guei-shen can be found in all aspects of nature according to Chinese religious beliefs. These beings were elevated to prominence in the Buddhist pantheon. These animals are highly valued. There are specters, goblins, and fairies, in addition to the various types of animals found in the natural world. Because demons dislike light, people in China who were influenced by Daoism and folk religions used bonfires, firecrackers, and torches to ward off the guei. Fireworks were also used for these purposes in China.

In Japanese, Chinese, and Japanese religions, as well as in Japanese faiths, mankind is expected to fight a wide range of malevolent spirits. Oni are malevolent spirits with enormous power, whereas tengu are spirits with the ability to possess humans. These can, in most cases, only be expelled with the help of priests. When these two types of Japanese demons are combined, they are often regarded as the most terrifying of all Japanese demons.

Spiritual beings are typically viewed as either malevolent or benevolent depending on the circumstances, rather than as a result of their inherent nature in nonliterate religions of Asia, Africa, Oceania, and the Americas. This is in contrast to the belief that spiritual beings are either good or evil by nature. The literate religions of Europe, on the other hand, regard spiritual beings as either malevolent or benevolent due to their inherent nature. This contradicts the popular belief that all spiritual beings are neutral.

This viewpoint on spiritual beings is unique when compared to the depiction of spiritual beings in literary religions, which typically cast them in either a negative or positive light. For example, the Yoruba people of Nigeria believe that the deity Eshu is both a benevolent and protective spirit and a malevolent spirit whose power can be used against one's enemies.

These individuals believe it is possible to use Eshu's power against their opponents. A large number of people believe that Eshu is both of these things. These beings have mana, which literally means "supernatural force" in the Melanesia language. These beings have the ability to control mana. A person of high status, such as a chief or a shaman, may be said to possess mana, a term that can refer to either spirits or other people.

Nature spirits are frequently venerated in nonliterate religions in exchange for specific favors or as a means of protection against natural disasters. This practice is similar to the veneration shown to the gods and goddesses who ruled over the natural world in ancient Rome. It is necessary to make peace with the souls of those who have died, to

appease the many ancestor gods that exist. It is often necessary to perform a number of elaborate rituals in order to achieve this goal.

In his book, *The Biblical Basis for Modern Science*, Henry Morris explains that the Bible takes a comprehensive approach to issues of worldview. This approach considers all aspects of human culture, including but not limited to science, technology, the humanities, business, the law, civil government, and education.

Another great commission was given to all people, whether or not they had accepted Christ as their Savior, simply because they were created in God's image. This commission had existed for a very long time before the formation of the Great Commission. Furthermore, it was accepted as legitimate in every country on the planet, and its legality was never called into question. It had to do with carrying out God's plan for His work on the creation, just as Christ's commission had to do with carrying out Christ's plan for saving and reconciling people. It was especially about carrying out God's plan in Christ's work to create the universe in the manner in which Christ was sent into the world.

According to Morris, the phrase "subdue the earth" refers to bringing "all of the earth's systems and processes to a state of optimum productivity and utility, offering the greatest honor to God and benefit to mankind."

As witnessed in this chapter, Christian depictions have impacted the world. We can also clearly see how everything is interconnected to one's mind and thought processes which are then further tied to their belief system. In this case, Christianity being the most global, diverse, and full of in-depth analysis, provides the best slate for one to work on their mental health.